

VER. 26.1

Authenticity

Side-pivoting visored Bascinets

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1. Implementation

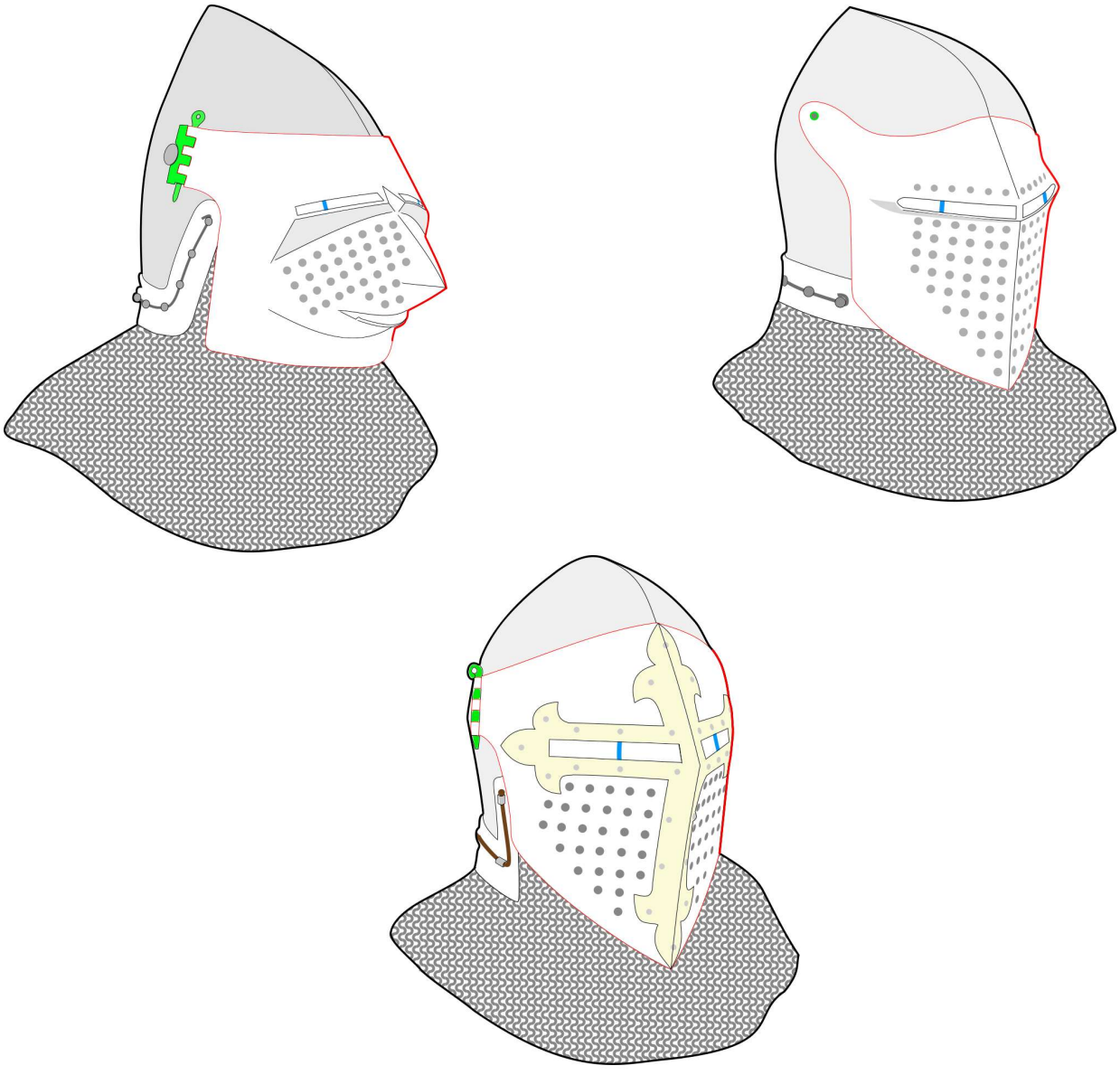
The document has been created and approved by the General Assembly of 09.11.2024.
The document and its rules have been implemented since the 2025 season.

2. Definition

Side-pivoting visored Bascinets are helmets with movable visors attached to the dome with pivots at the temples, in contrast to center-mounted hinges on the forehead. This type of helmet was very popular in Western Europe from 1350 to 1450. Such helmets are designed to be worn as primary head protection, and the design of the visor is made to deflect strikes.

Side-pivoting visored Bascinets use a solid metal visor to protect the face, attached on the sides by pivots.

Side-pivoting visored Bascinets were used from the early 14th century to 1450 across all of Western Europe. The shape of the visor will evolve throughout time.



3. Historical Sources and Datation

3.1. 14th Century Sugarloaf Helmets

Sugarloaf helmets are one of the earliest types of Side-pivoting visored Bascinets. It appeared at the beginning of the 14th century and includes a solid chin protection, derived from Great helms design.

Sugarloaf helmets are **Approved** for **14th century armors.**

Sugarloaf helmets are **Denied** for **Transitional** and **15th century armors.**



BL Royal 6 E IX Address in verse to Robert of Anjou, King of Naples - 1335/1340 - Italy

3.2. Transitional Style Helmets

In the middle of the 14th century, Bascinets with a side-pivoting visor began to be depicted in miniatures and art. They include a longer visor with no chin plate and will represent the majority of helmets until the middle of the 15th century.

Transitional style helmets are **Approved** for **14th century** and **Transitional armors.**

Transitional style helmets are **Denied** for **15th century armors.**

3.2.1. Romance of Alexander, Spoleto, and Other Flat-faced Bascinets

These helmets are based on period art:



Spoleto church - 1370/1380 - Italy



Codex Balduini Trevirensis - 1341 - Germany



Morgan Library - 1390-1399 - France



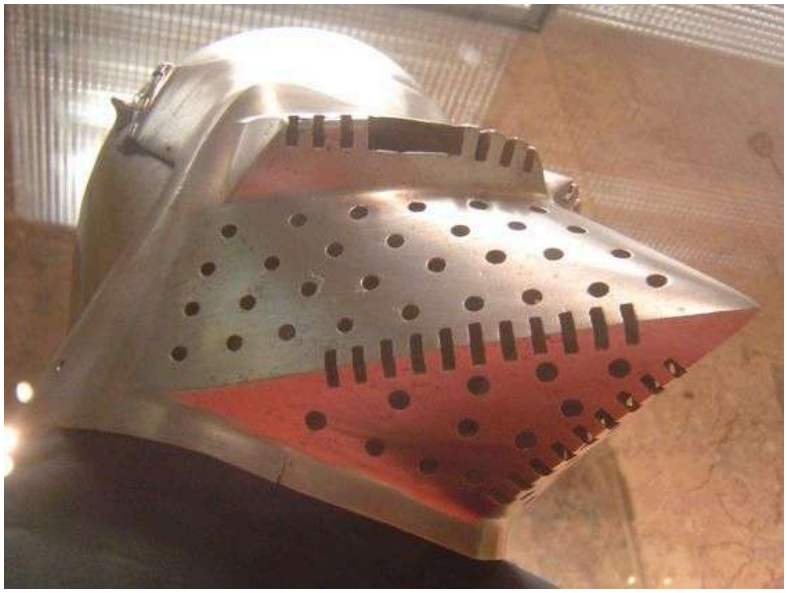
Holkham Bible - 1327/1335 - England



Romance of Alexander - 1338 - England

3.2.2. Houndskull/Hundsgugel Style Bascinets

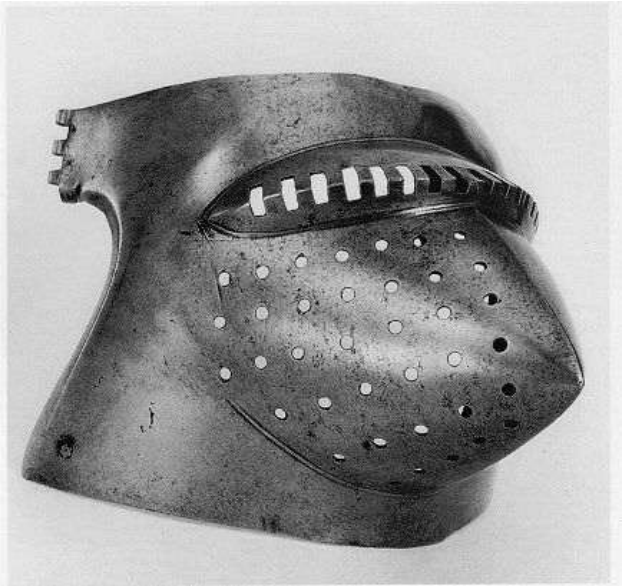
These helmets are very common at this time. Many originals survived and are displayed in museums.



1400-1410 - Kunsthistorisches Museum Wien - Austria



Bodleian Library - 1400/1425 - England



1390-1410 - Churburg - Italy



Les Grandes Chroniques de France - 1400/1425 - France

3.3. 15th century Style Helmets

At the edge of the 15th century, an evolution of previous Bascinets was developed. The great Bascinet encompasses an increased neck protection that makes it very safe. Some extant artifacts are displayed in museums.



Musée de l'Armée, Paris - 1400/1420 - France



Musées des Beaux Arts, Dijon - 1400/1420 - France



Doges Palace, Venice - 1380/1390 - Italy

4. Requirements

4.1. General Requirements

Reproductions must closely resemble the appearance and proportions of a Side-pivoting Bascinet source.

Any metal part of the helmet must conform to the *"Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations"* document.

Any textile or leather part of the helmet must conform to the "*Textiles and Leather"* document.

4.2. Visor

The visor must not be too long or too short, it must conform to the proportions of historical sources.

The pivots must be reproduced as per historical sources.

It is permitted to weld the visor down. A welded visor must resemble a functional removable visor.

It is permitted to add metal plates to protect the throat. Such a plate must be strong enough to endure full-contact fighting and must be concealed under the aventail.

A leather strap can be used to secure the visor.

Breath holes should be round and must not exceed a diameter of 10 mm. Breath holes must not be so numerous that they compromise the helm's structural integrity. It is acceptable to mirror breath holes to both sides.

Breath holes of other shapes must be documented by historical sources to be permitted.

4.3. Eye slots

Eye slots should resemble sources for the visor.

Eye slots should not exceed 25 mm tall to prevent any injury.

Side-pivoting visored Bascinets with historical evidence of externally riveted Eye bars can add up to two (2) externally riveted eye bars per eye slot.

Helmets that are currently documented with externally riveted Eye bars are Sugarloaf and Romance of Alexander.

Side-pivoting visored Bascinets with two (2) Eye slots are permitted to add up to two (2) safety Eye bars per Eye slot.

Side-pivoting visored Bascinets with a single Eye slot are permitted to add up to five (5) safety Eye bars: one (1) in the middle and two (2) on each side.

Example:



Picture from Medieval Extreme ©

Side-pivoting visored Bascinets with historical evidence of integrated Eye bars can use some, such as the following:





BL Royal 20 C VII
Chroniques de France ou de St Denis -
1380/1400 - France

Eye bars must conform to the "*Eye bars*" document.

4.4. Aventail

Side-pivoting visored Bascinets must be worn with chainmail Aventails, fabric Aventails, or scales Aventails.

Aventails must conform to the "*Aventails"* document.

Aventails must be attached to the Bascinet by a system of leather and vervelles, or sewn to the edges of the helmet.

Chainmail Aventail must be fastened down to the edge of a padded pelerine, attached to the helmet liner.

Scales and fabric Aventails are recommended to be fastened down to the edge of a padded pelerine, attached to the helmet liner.

Any additional protective plates covering the cervical spine should be hidden under the Aventail.

4.5. Others

Side-pivoting visored Bascinets may be decorated in the spirit of medieval styles, such as an orle, torse, decorated aventails (with copper/brass chainmail rings), vervelle covers, coat of arms badges, etc.

Such decoration must be made in coherence with historical sources.

Using modern and/or offensive imagery and slogans is prohibited as part of decorations or heraldry.

5.Examples of Approved Reproductions

5.1. Sugarloaf



Picture from Age of Craft ©



Picture from Forge of Svan ©

5.2. Romance of Alexander, Spoleto, and Other Flat-faced Bascinets





Pictures from Master Uley ©



Pictures from Medieval Extreme ©



Pictures from The Medieval Things ©



Picture from Zoom en Lice ©

5.3. Houndskull/Hundsgugel Style Bascinets





Pictures from The Medieval Things ©



Picture from Medieval Extreme ©

5.4. Great Bascinets



Picture from The Medieval Things ©

6. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Too many eye bars, not painted in black.
Eye slots are too tall, the safest option is to
choose a helmet with thinner eye slots as per sources.





Design of the bottom of the visor does not reproduce historical sources.



Additional plate must be concealed

Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

7. Changelog

Below, we will keep track of all the changes made over the lifetime of this document. This way, all our members can see how the documents are changing over time.

January - 2026 (V. 26.1)
Formatting redone for consistency and readability. Except points listed below, no content changes.
Replace:
Throughout the document "Side-hinged visored Bascinets" by "Side-pivoting visored Bascinets"
Add: "1. Implementation" (and subsequent modification of all Title numbers in the document)
Suppression:
- In 3.2 Transitional Style Helmets: "(such as sugarloaf)"
- In 4.3 Eye slots: "internal"
- In 4.4 Aventails "Supplemental hidden collar plates are permitted."

Add:
- In 4.3 Eye slots: "per eye slot"
- In 4.4 Aventails: "Scales and Fabric aventails are recommended to be fastened down to the edge of a padded pelerine, attached to the helmet liner."

Replace:
- In 4.4 Aventails: "The aventail must be fastened down to the outer edge of a padded pelerine attached to the helmet liner."

by "Chainmail aventail must be fastened down to the edge of a padded pelerine, attached to the helmet liner."

February-2025 (V2025.03)
- clarification: 3.3
- formatting: Grammar and Formatting

December-2024: -Add
Document has been created